of new ideas. Normally, when it comes to diplomacy, analysis focusses on how we see the world and all its complications. Sometimes, it is useful to invert that and reflect on how the world, on its part, could be visualizing India and the opportunities there.

India’s rise is a relentless exercise where the sensible only pause to take stock, never to declare victory. Without neglecting the past, it works best when our eyes are fixed firmly on the horizons and we read the international situation right as well as fashion our strategies and tactics accordingly. But to do all this and more, it is essential that Bharat is true to itself, its interests and its ambitions.